
Financial market participation 2020, 2023–2026

Overview of activity across FX, futures, equities and related markets.

Five calendar years, six markets and three paths in: the journey so far

5 calendar years of participation	\$2,846 total capital deployed in markets	2,124 trades logged	6 market types: FX, futures, stocks, commodities, metals, crypto
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How it began. The journey started in March 2020, when a first personal account was opened as COVID volatility peaked. After a pause, participation resumed in September 2023 and has been continuous since, so it now spans five calendar years: 2020, and 2023 to 2026.

How it broadened. From 2023 the journey widened beyond currencies (foreign exchange, or FX) to oil and gold, then in 2024 to silver, US index futures, Bitcoin and Nigerian stocks, and in 2025 to US stocks. Three paths in have been used: personal accounts; accounts with proprietary trading firms ("prop firms"), each beginning as a paid evaluation of trading ability; and the US Equity Account, a longer-horizon US stock account. Together that is 19 accounts and 2,124 trades.

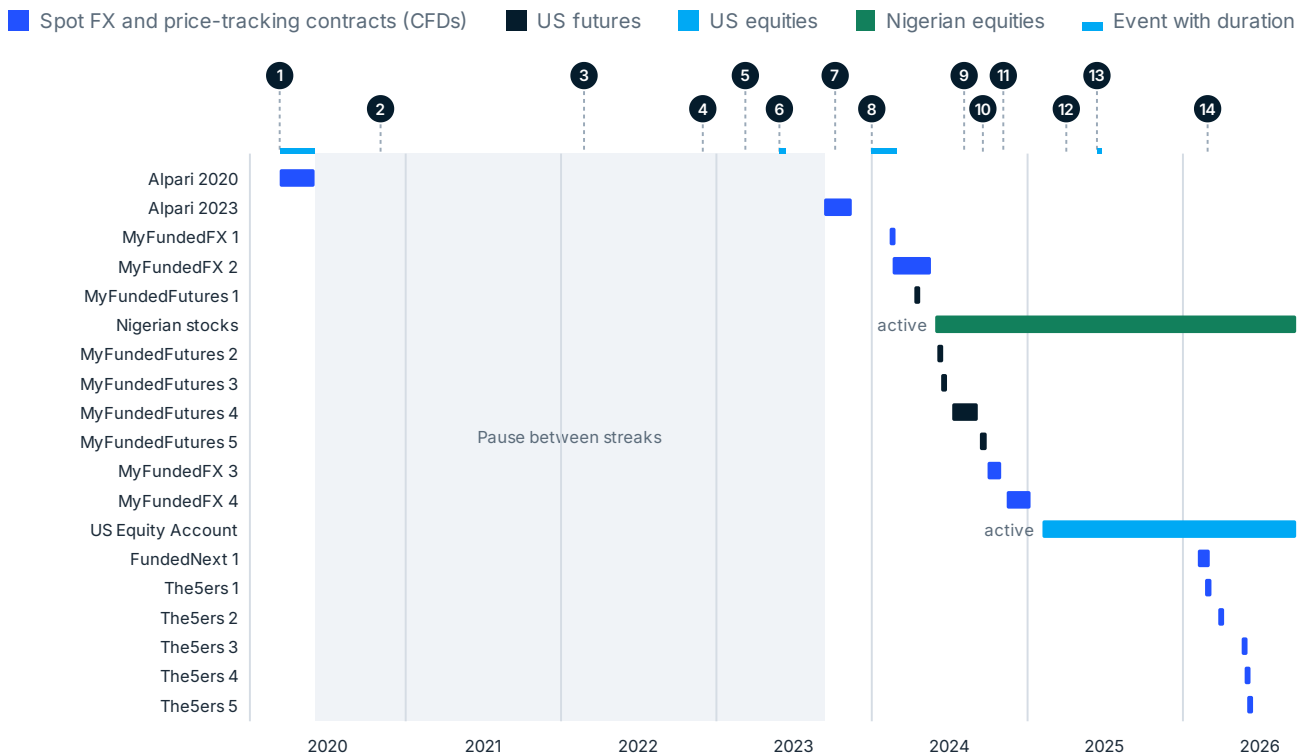
Prop firms. 15 prop-firm accounts were run, paying \$1,016 in fees. They provided \$291,000 of account capacity and produced an account-level result of -5.4%. Two stages were passed; no payouts have been received.

The equity accounts. Both are active. The US Equity Account, trading on the NYSE and Nasdaq, earned **+\$681** on \$1,000 (68%). The Nigerian stock account, traded on the Nigerian Exchange (NGX), earned **₦92,037** net of fees on **₦220,793** of capital at its peak (42%).

Current position. By September 2026 the net result stood at -\$886. 2025 and 2026 each finished the year net positive, led by the two equity accounts. An interim low of -\$1,702 occurred in Mar 2026, when new prop-firm fees were paid before that year's gains came through. The journey drew on personal (24%), friend (49%) and family (27%) capital, of which 61% went into US instruments, 35% into global FX and 4% into Nigerian stocks. **₦400,000** of **₦720,000** has been repaid to one family lender, and the US Equity Account has paid out \$1,458 since it opened.

Figures reflect money that actually moved: prop-firm fees paid, and results from closed trades in personal accounts and the two equity accounts. Evaluation-account profit and loss, which stayed inside the evaluation and was never received, is reported separately as a memo item.

Participation has run in two streaks: 2020, then continuously since September 2023



2020. One personal FX account, opened as COVID volatility peaked. **September 2023 to date.** The second streak began with a personal account and nine prop-firm accounts in FX and index futures through 2024. Nigerian stocks started in 2024 and the US Equity Account in 2025, and six further prop-firm accounts ran in 2026. Both equity accounts remain active. Numbered markers refer to the events on the next page.

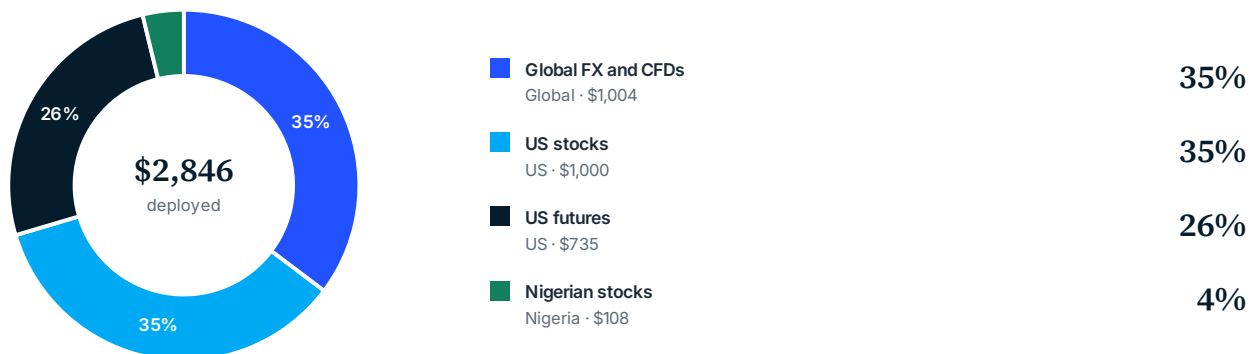
Each phase of participation overlapped a major macro or geopolitical shock

#	Period	Event	Relevance to the markets traded
1	11 Mar 2020 – 1 Jun 2020	COVID-19 pandemic and market crash	Record volatility; first live account (Alpari 2020) traded through it
2	3 Nov 2020	US presidential election	Rotation and volatility in US equities and the dollar
3	24 Feb 2022	Russia–Ukraine war begins	Energy and grain shock; commodity and inflation repricing (no participation, 2021–22)
4	30 Nov 2022	ChatGPT released	Start of the AI investment cycle behind later US equity leadership
5	10 Mar 2023	Silicon Valley Bank collapse	Regional-bank stress; rates repriced
6	29 May 2023 – 14 Jun 2023	Nigeria: subsidy removal and FX unification	Naira devalued; reshaped the cost of dollar capital
7	7 Oct 2023	Israel–Hamas war begins	Oil and gold volatility; Alpari 2023 traded WTI and gold
8	1 Jan 2024 – 29 Feb 2024	Naira sell-off	Peak dollar cost for Nigerian funders during the 2024 evaluations
9	5 Aug 2024	Yen carry-trade unwind	Sharp fall across markets during the futures evaluations
10	18 Sept 2024	Fed begins cutting rates	Start of the easing cycle
11	5 Nov 2024	US presidential election	Trend day for US indices and the dollar
12	2 Apr 2025	US “Liberation Day” tariffs	Global equity sell-off and rebound; the US Equity Account’s first year
13	13 Jun 2025 – 24 Jun 2025	Israel–Iran 12-day war	Oil and gold spike
14	28 Feb 2026	Iran war and Strait of Hormuz crisis (ongoing)	Oil spike toward \$120 (Brent); US blockade of Iranian ports 13 Apr–29 May; Nigerian stock gains in 2026

Dates for 2026 events are from public reporting as of September 2026; the Hormuz crisis is ongoing.

61% of capital went to US markets and 35% to global FX; Nigerian equities are a small third leg

Where the capital went, by market



By region: US 61%, Global 35%, Nigeria 4%.

By market type

Market type	Region	Path	Trades	Share of trades	Result
Futures	US	Prop-firm & personal	1,092	51%	-\$13,948
Equity indices (CFDs)	US	Prop-firm & personal	48	2%	-\$368
US stocks	US	Equity account	350	16%	+\$681
Nigerian stocks	Nigeria	Equity account	29	1%	+\$67
FX	Global	Prop-firm & personal	269	13%	-\$1,398
Commodities	Global	Prop-firm & personal	302	14%	-\$438
Metals	Global	Prop-firm & personal	30	1%	-\$276
Crypto	Global	Prop-firm & personal	4	0%	-\$6
Total			2,124	100%	-\$15,686

US covers futures, equity indices (CFDs) and the US Equity Account. Global covers FX, commodities, metals and crypto, all traded through contracts for difference (CFDs), which track a price without owning the asset. Crypto is four BTCUSD trades in one 2024 evaluation. Prop-firm and personal-account results are account-level, including evaluation accounts; equity-account results are realised gains, with Nigerian stocks converted to USD at prevailing monthly rates.

Prop evaluations: 15 attempts, \$1,016 in fees, \$291,000 of account capacity

15 prop-firm accounts across four firms provided \$291,000 of account capacity, for \$1,016 in fees (0.35% of capacity). The aggregate account-level result was -5.4%. Two stages were passed at The5ers; no payouts have been received.

Entry path	Accounts	Capital deployed	Result	Status
Retail investing (personal accounts)	3: Alpari 2020, Alpari 2023, Nigerian stocks	\$830	-\$551	Alpari closed; Nigerian stocks active
Prop firms	15: four firms	\$1,016	- \$1,016	All closed; 0 payouts
US Equity Account	1: a longer-horizon equity account	\$1,000	+\$681	Active
Total	19	\$2,846	-\$886	

Prop firms: totals by firm

Firm	Accounts	Size per account	Total account size	Total fees paid	Total account-level result	% of total size	Stages passed
MyFundedFutures	5	\$50,000	\$250,000	\$734.50	-\$13,948	-5.6%	0
MyFundedFX	4	\$5,000	\$20,000	\$148.22	-\$1,602	-8.0%	0
FundedNext	1	\$6,000	\$6,000	\$63.21	-\$361	-6.0%	0
The5ers	5	\$2,500-\$5,000	\$15,000	\$70.50	+\$94	+0.6%	2
All four firms	15		\$291,000	\$1,016.43	-\$15,817	-5.4%	2

Totals are summed across each firm's accounts, and each account is counted at its full size, including later stages of the same evaluation.

Evaluation fees by firm

MyFundedFutures	\$735
MyFundedFX	\$148
FundedNext	\$63
The5ers	\$71

Three of the five MyFundedFutures evaluations ended at about -4% (\$2,000 each), consistent with a fixed maximum-loss rule set by the firm. Retail accounts are self-directed personal accounts. The other path is the US Equity Account, a longer-horizon account traded since February 2025. Both stages passed were at The5ers in May 2026.

Personal capital reached every path except the two equity accounts; friends and family added the rest

Personal capital (IF) is part of five of the seven destinations below — every path except the two equity accounts — and made up 24% of the \$2,846 deployed. Friends contributed 49%, most of it into the US Equity Account; family contributed 27%, mostly into the MyFundedFutures evaluations and the Nigerian stock account.

Capital deployed by source

IF	PO	TA	MO	BA
24%	6%	44%	13%	14%
\$679	\$163	\$1,240	\$361	\$403

IF: personal TA, PO: friends (TA a close friend; PO contributed in 2020 only) MO, BA: family

Where each source went (USD)

Destination	Personal (IF)	Friend (PO)	Friend (TA)	Family (MO)	Family (BA)	Total
Alpari 2020	131.58	163.13				294.71
Alpari 2023	75.35		156.27	195.64		427.26
MyFundedFX evaluations (4)	64.22		84.00			148.22
MyFundedFutures evaluations (5)	274.50			165.00	295.00	734.50
FundedNext and The5ers evaluations (6)	133.71					133.71
US Equity Account			1,000.00			1,000.00
Nigerian stocks (brokerage account)					107.64	107.64
Total	679.36	163.13	1,240.27	360.64	402.64	2,846.04

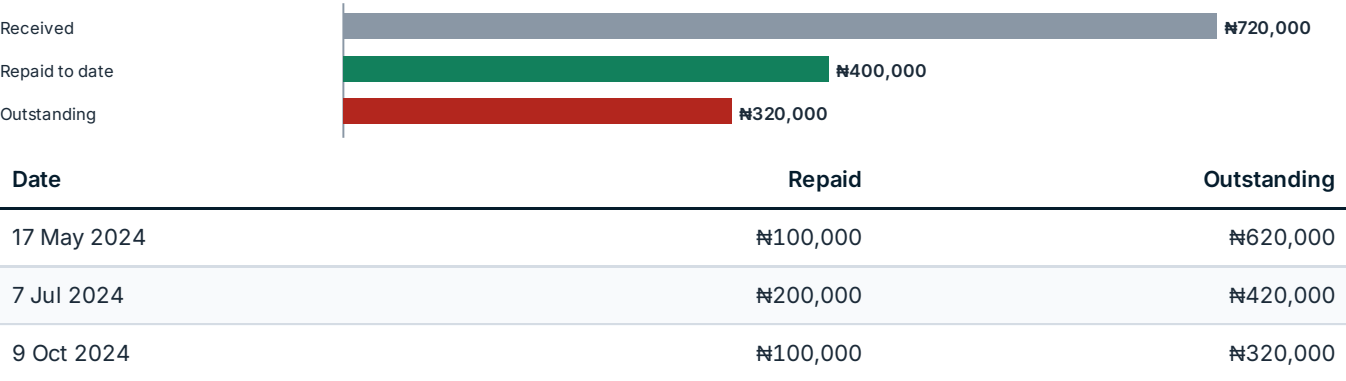
Received versus deployed (family, ₦)

Source	Received	Deployed in markets	Into operations
MO	₦720,000	≈ ₦398,000	≈ ₦322,000
BA	₦1,000,000	₦592,500	₦407,500

Return of capital has begun, and the US Equity Account pays out its gains

Partial return of capital has begun: ₦400,000 of ₦720,000 has been repaid to one family lender, and the US Equity Account has paid out \$1,458 since it opened.

Repayments to family lender MO (₦)



Outstanding shown in payment order; the source log lists the 9 Oct 2024 payment first.

US Equity Account: capital, profit and payouts (USD)



21 payouts total \$1,458.39 since Sep 2025, split 55% to the account holder and 45% to TA, in pounds sterling. They exceed cumulative trading profit of \$680.85, so they include a partial return of the capital TA put in; the implied balance is \$222.46.

Source	Nature of return		Status
IF (personal)	None expected		–
PO, TA (friends)	TA: payouts from the US Equity Account. PO: none		TA receiving; PO none
MO (family)	Repayment of credit		₦400,000 of ₦720,000
BA (family)	Repayment target		None yet

Returning capital to every source remains a stated target for the journey.

Year-end results turned positive in 2025 and 2026, after a low at the end of 2024

By year (USD)

Year	Personal accounts	Prop fees	US Equity Account	Nigerian stocks	Net result	Net result %
2020	-\$293				-\$293	-99.3%
2023	-\$325				-\$325	-76.0%
2024		-\$883		+\$1	-\$881	-89.0%
2025			+\$68	-\$1	+\$67	+5.9%
2026		-\$134	+\$612	+\$67	+\$545	+43.9%
Total	-\$618	-\$1,016	+\$681	+\$67	-\$886	-31.1%

Net result % compares each year's result with the capital in active accounts that year, not with the full \$2,846 deployed over the whole period. The chart below tracks the same idea continuously, from the first account to today.

■ Personal accounts ■ Prop-firm evaluations ■ Equity accounts

Cumulative result as a share of capital committed



Each month's figure is the running result divided by the running capital committed since the first account. For prop-firm accounts, capital committed is the fee paid; for personal accounts and the two equity accounts, it is the capital placed in the account.

Prop-firm evaluations dominate the result; the two equity accounts are the exception

By path, result against its own base

Path	Base	Base amount	Result	Result %
Personal FX accounts (2)	Capital deployed	\$722	-\$618	-85.6%
Nigerian stocks	Peak capital committed	₦220,793	+₦92,037	+41.7%
US Equity Account	Capital contributed	\$1,000	+\$681	+68.1%
Prop-firm fees	Account size	\$291,000	-\$1,016	-0.35%
Prop-firm accounts, account level	Account size	\$291,000	-\$15,817	-5.4%

Nigerian stocks are shown in naira; every other row is in USD.

By market type, account-level result including evaluation accounts



Status: 17 accounts closed, 2 active. Nigerian stocks in naira: ₦111,942 gross, ₦19,905 fees, ₦92,037 net across 29 closed trades.

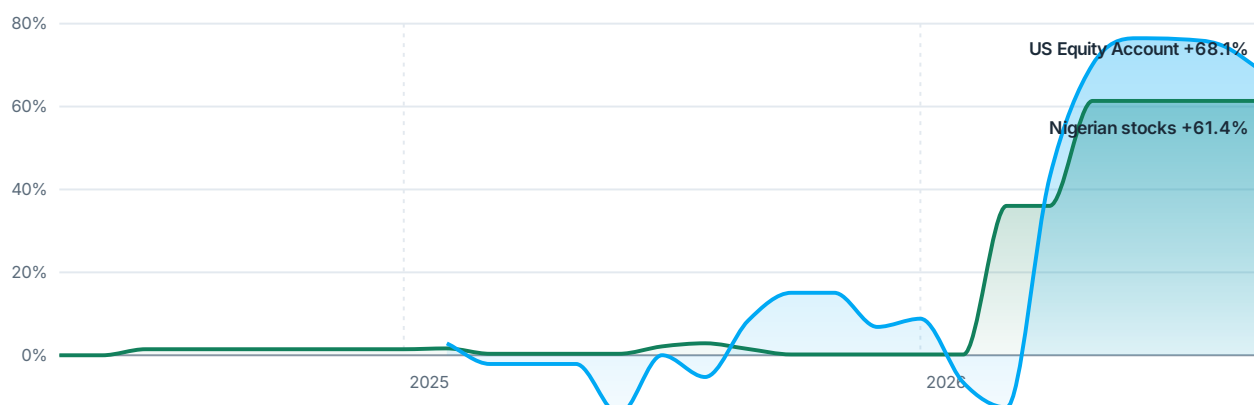
Both equity accounts are active: the US Equity Account is up 68% and Nigerian stocks 42% on capital committed at its peak

Results are realised gains only, meaning positions that have been sold. Nigerian stock results are after fees.

Fund	Started	Peak capital	Realised result	Return	Closed trades
US Equity Account	Feb 2025	\$1,000	+\$681	+68.1%	350
Nigerian stocks	May 2024	₦220,793	+₦92,037	+41.7%	29

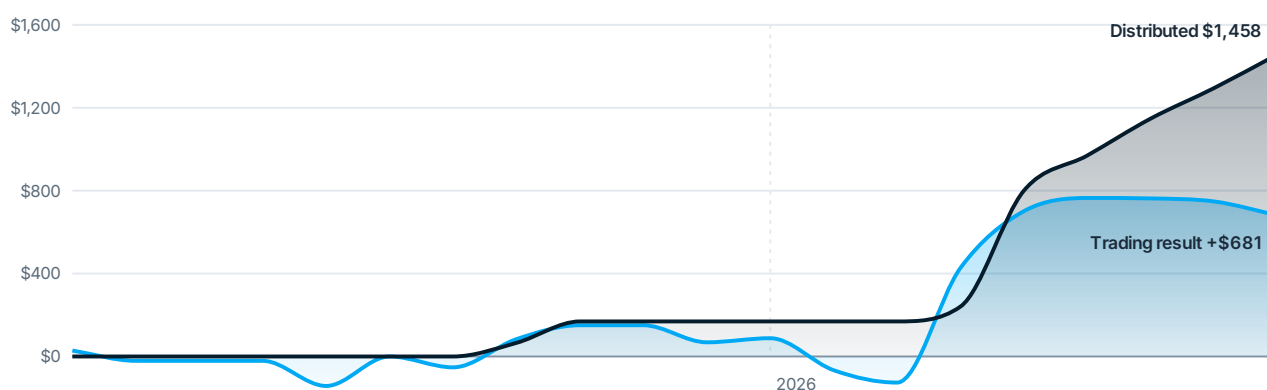
Cumulative return on capital contributed (%)

■ US Equity Account ■ Nigerian stocks



US Equity Account: cumulative trading result and payouts (USD)

■ Trading result ■ Paid out



Distributions so far total \$1,458 against a cumulative trading result of \$681. The return of capital page shows how they were split between the account holder and TA.

The approach is pattern recognition, and trading has become more selective: 164 trades per account in 2024, 27 in 2026

Primary approach. Generating value from the markets through the application of the art, science and technology of pattern recognition.

Art

Reading structure, context and behaviour in price: the discretionary judgement of what a pattern means now.

Science

Testing whether a pattern repeats with an edge: samples, expectancy and risk limits rather than anecdote.

Technology

Encoding what works into indicators, dashboards and automated systems so it can be applied without drift.

Supporting lenses

Lens	Role
Technical analysis	Structure, levels, momentum and reversal signals across FX, futures and stocks
Fundamentals	Sector and company selection for the equity accounts, including thematic sector intelligence
Events	Macro and geopolitical catalysts: rates, elections, wars, supply shocks (see events, page 4)

How trading has changed since 2024

Prop-firm accounts opened in	2024	2026
Number of accounts	9	6
Average trades per account	164	27
Most trades in one account	584	76
Result against account size	-5.8%	-1.3%
Accounts finishing positive	0 of 9	2 of 6

In plain terms: fewer trades per account, smaller losses against account size, and the first accounts to finish ahead. There were only 15 accounts, with different firms and account sizes each year. Averages use the accounts that have trade records.

Tooling built along the way

Rule-based systems and dashboards are part of the approach: automated trading rules for two trading platforms, an intraday trading engine, charting indicators, and a sector-intelligence tool.

Basis of preparation

Basis of the figures. Personal accounts show the account's realised result; prop firms show the evaluation fee paid, not the evaluation account's own profit or loss; funds show trading result before payouts to those with a stake in the account. Evaluation-account profit and loss is reported separately, as a memo item.

Currency. Reported in USD. Nigerian stock results are recorded in naira and converted to USD at approximate monthly ₦/\$ levels: recorded rates for 2024 and published Central Bank of Nigeria levels for 2025–26 (about ₦1,360–1,530). Family amounts are shown in naira as recorded.

Nigerian stocks. Gains are shown net of fees: ₦111,942 gross, less ₦19,905 in fees, for ₦92,037 net. One open position (6 shares of Geregu Power, bought for ₦5,400) has not been sold and is excluded from the results; it was running ₦446 below cost. This account has no separate deposit log, so its capital is estimated from the trade record itself: the largest amount ever tied up at one time, tracking each purchase and sale in order. That peak, ₦220,793, was reached in March 2026 and is used as the capital base for its return.

Data gaps. A few accounts rely on account-level summaries rather than complete trade-by-trade records — Alpari 2020, two of the MyFundedFX evaluations, and Alpari 2023. These differences are minor and do not change the overall picture.

Other notes. No prop payouts, no other accounts, and no participation in 2021–22.

Sources. Account and trade-level portfolio records, Nigerian stock trade records, and the family credit and repayment log. Event dates are from public reporting. Data as of September 2026.

Terms. A prop firm is a proprietary trading firm that lets a trader use its account after passing a paid evaluation. FX is trading one currency against another; futures are standardised contracts on an index or commodity. A CFD is a contract for difference, which tracks a price without owning the asset. NGX is the Nigerian Exchange, where Nigerian stocks are traded. Alpari is the online broker used for the two personal accounts.